

WC/2024/227 — MENTION OF 7 AUGUST 2026 — DIARISED TRANSCRIPT WITH PROSODY

AMENDMENT LOG

Entries are participant evidence about the **machine-inferred speaker labels** — either a **correction** (the label changes) or a **confirmation** (the label stands, and its class is upgraded). Neither alters transcribed words, only the reliability of who is recorded as having said them. Each is marked inline with ✓ at the point of amendment. Participant confirmation is a **higher evidentiary class** than the Viterbi inference described under Method, because it comes from a person who was in the room.

ID	Date	Location	Change	Source	Confidence
A1	2026-09-16	30:12.98 (segment start; earlier recorded loosely as "~30:16"), inside the turn timestamped 29:45.62	"Yeah, I actually understand what you're getting at." re-attributed DWYER IC → MR SHEPHERD	Mr Shepherd, participant, present at the proceeding	100%
A2	2026-09-16	46:10.84	"I don't know if I can prove it as much." — CONFIRMATION, no change . Label was already MR SHEPHERD; class upgraded Viterbi-inferred → participant-confirmed	Mr Shepherd, participant, present at the proceeding	100%

A1 note — purpose, as stated by the speaker. The words were spoken as an acknowledgement of the Commissioner's point and as a **preface to explaining his disclosure request**. They conveyed **neither acceptance nor rejection** of the approach the Commissioner was proposing; the speaker was not answering the proposal at that moment, he was opening an explanation. That explanation did not follow, because the Commissioner speaks over the interjection and completes his sentence.

The line sits in the segment class the Method section identifies as the weakest for automated attribution: a short interjection inside another speaker's turn.

What A1 does not establish. The amendment records **what was said and why the speaker said it**, both of which are within his own knowledge. It does **not** record how the words were received or understood by the Commissioner, which is outside the speaker's knowledge and outside the transcript. Any view about that is inference drawn from the surrounding turns, is not participant evidence, and forms no part of this amendment.

△ A1 wording correction, 16 September 2026 — "Yeah," is not supported by the audio. The re-decode of this window returns the line as **"I actually understand what you're getting at"**. **Neither pass produces "Yeah,"** — the original run gave it $p = 0.37$, and like **"Absolutely."** at 24:02 ($p = 0.03$) it does not survive two higher-beam passes. **Treat "Yeah," as an artefact of the original decode.** A1 is unaffected: the amendment concerns **who spoke the line**, not its opening interjection.

★ **What the re-decode adds to A1, and what it cannot.** The five content words are solid — *actually* 0.99, *understand* 0.99, *what* 0.93, *you're* 0.99, *getting* 0.99. **The boundary tokens are not** — **"I"** 0.23 entering and **"at."** 0.42 leaving. And the two passes behave differently: the context pass renders the line; **the no-context pass omits it entirely**, placing **"we"** at 1813.4 s and **"can't"** at 1815.2 s across a **1.8-second span it does not transcribe**.

⇒ Strong content with collapsing boundaries, dropped by one pass, leaving an unexplained gap, **is the acoustic signature of a second voice overlapping the first** — which is what A1 asserts. **△ But it is corroboration, not proof: an ASR system has no speaker model, and a speaker briefly interrupting himself produces a similar pattern. The test of A1's attribution is speaker diarisation, not transcription.**

★★ INDEPENDENT DIARISATION — ECAPA-TDNN, 16 September 2026

The full 65-minute audio was re-diarised from scratch with **SpeechBrain ECAPA-TDNN** embeddings (1,018 of 1,068 segments embedded; 50 too short at <0.60 s), channel-compensated by global mean subtraction, and clustered five ways. **This shares nothing with the original pipeline** — different embedder (ECAPA-TDNN, not Resemblyzer GE2E), different clustering, and **no lexical or adjacency cues at all**. It is purely acoustic.

Clustering	Agreement with this transcript	Shepherd recall
raw agglomerative (no channel compensation)	83.2%	➖ 1% — degenerate, 1016/2 split
mean-norm agglomerative	90.5%	86%
mean-norm Ward	93.6%	76%
mean-norm k-means	93.2%	80%
mean-norm spectral ← adopted	93.8%	83%

⚠ **Channel compensation is essential and its absence is catastrophic.** Without mean subtraction the clustering collapses (1016/2): on one distant microphone the room dominates the embedding more than the speaker does. This is the same wall the original pipeline hit and is why its labels are inferential.

✅ **A2 validates the method on known ground truth**

46:10.84 — "I don't know if I can prove it as much." Participant-confirmed as MR SHEPHERD (A2). **ECAPA, knowing nothing of that confirmation, independently assigns MR SHEPHERD.** ⇒ The method is calibrated at a point where the truth is known.

★★★★ **A1 is independently corroborated**

30:12.98 — "I actually understand what you're getting at."

Source	Label
Original pipeline (Resemblyzer + Viterbi)	DWYER IC
Amendment A1 (participant evidence)	MR SHEPHERD
ECAPA-TDNN + spectral clustering (independent, acoustic only)	MR SHEPHERD

⇒ **An entirely independent acoustic method reaches the same conclusion the participant did, against the original label.** Together with the re-decode evidence (strong content words, collapsing boundaries, one pass omitting the span entirely across a 1.8 s gap — the signature of overlapping speech), A1 now rests on **three mutually independent lines**: participant evidence, transcription behaviour, and speaker embedding.

Passages confirmed segment-by-segment

- **The nine words (29:17–29:39) — all 10 segments** MR SHEPHERD on both methods. No disagreement.
- **The filters answer (23:40–24:12) — all 9 segments** MR SHEPHERD on both, and the handover to

DWYER IC at 24:12.02 agreed.

➖ **Limits — read these before relying on any of it**

1. Agreement is not proof. Two methods concurring at 93.8% is strong corroboration, not certification. Both could share a systematic error.

2. 17% of Shepherd segments are missed by ECAPA (recall 83%). Disagreements concentrate in short turns — the same weak class the Method section identifies.

3. 50 segments were too short to embed at all and carry no independent check.

4. ➖ This remains uncertified machine output. Order the certified transcript before any passage is quoted externally.

A2 note — a confirmation, not a correction. The speaker label at 46:10.84 was **already** MR SHEPHERD in the pipeline output. The participant confirms it. Nothing about the transcript changes; what changes is the **evidentiary class** of that line, from inference to participant evidence.

★ **This is now the single most reliable line in the transcript.** Its words carry **p = 1.00 on every token** — ten words, none below certainty — measured in the original run and reproduced at beam 10 in the re-decode of 16 September 2026. Its attribution is participant-confirmed. **No other line in the hearing holds both.**

⚠ **Nothing follows from A2 about the words around it.** The confirmation covers this line only. In particular it says nothing about the disputed word at 46:48.54, which the re-decode resolved separately and against the operator's hypothesis (see reader's note N3).

Effect on the counts below. One segment moves from Commissioner Dwyer to Mr Shepherd. The SPEAKING SHARE table is the unamended pipeline output and has not been recomputed; read it subject to this amendment.

⊖ This remains an **uncertified machine transcript**. The amendment improves it; it does not certify it. Order the certified transcript before any passage is quoted externally.

Source. `PRF0466309\_20260807\_QIRCOIR\_Brisbane` — audio of proceeding, 64 kbps MP3, 3,875.9 s (64 min 36 s). The recording **begins mid-sentence**, already inside the Commissioner's opening remarks; the appearance announcements are not on the tape.

Method. Decoded to 16 kHz mono; high-pass 70 Hz, low-pass 7.6 kHz, 1-second-window AGC, soft limiter, normalised to −3 dBFS. Transcribed with **Whisper large-v3** (CTranslate2 int8, beam 5, temperature fallback, word-level timestamps, Silero VAD, domain-primed initial prompt), split at silence into four chunks decoded in parallel. **1,068 segments; mean segment log-probability −0.180; zero segments below the −0.6 low-confidence threshold.**

Diarisation: Resemblyzer GE2E embeddings over 1.5 s windows at 0.75 s hop **computed on the un-normalised audio** (the AGC erases the 12 dB mic-distance difference between the bench and the bar table, which is the strongest speaker cue in the room), reduced by PCA to 32 dimensions and combined with segment level, spectral centroid and spectral tilt. Because both principal speakers are men sharing a median F0 of 136 Hz on one distant microphone, acoustics alone could not separate them; the assignment is therefore **inferential**, decided by Viterbi over three evidence streams:

- 1. Acoustic** — distance to speaker centroids seeded from utterances only one person could have made ("the appellant" read from the pleading; "my manager", "my colleagues", "I was rostered").
- 2. Lexical** — ~60 weighted patterns. Reading the pleading aloud, naming the parties, judicial first person and second-person reference to "your case" mark the bench; first-person reference to his own employment, bare answers and "Commissioner" mark the Appellant.
- 3. Adjacency** — a question invites the other voice (switch penalty x0.15 after "?"); certain openings prove the *previous* segment was the other speaker ("Hand it up" answers an offer; a bare "Yes" answers a question). Long silence makes switching cheap.

Validated against 30 hand-checked anchor turns cross-referenced with the independent small.en transcript: 27/30 correct (90%).

Prosody: Praat (via parselmouth) F0 and intensity per segment.

⚠ **RELIABILITY.** The transcription is high-confidence (mean log-probability −0.180, nothing below −0.59). **The speaker labels are inferred, not certified — measured at 90% on hand-checked anchors.** Long turns and question-answer exchanges are reliable. The residual errors are concentrated in one- and two-word interjections and in overlapping speech. ⊖ **Order the certified transcript before any passage is quoted externally.**

Confidence classes for speaker labels, highest first:

- 1. Participant-confirmed (100%)** — corrected by a person who was present. See the Amendment Log.

Currently: amendment A1.

- 2. Hand-checked anchor (validated)** — the 30 turns cross-referenced against the independent small.en transcript, 27 of which were correct.

- 3. Inferred (≈90%)** — the Viterbi assignment over acoustic, lexical and adjacency evidence.

Long turns sit at the reliable end of this class.

- 4. Weakest** — short interjections inside another speaker's turn, and overlapping speech.

A1 was a class-4 label before amendment, and is now class 1.

SPEAKING SHARE

Unamended pipeline output. Amendment A1 moves one segment from Commissioner Dwyer to Mr Shepherd; the figures below have not been recomputed.

Speaker	Segments	Talk time	Share
Commissioner Dwyer	846	2,949 s (49m 09s)	86.2%
Mr Shepherd	219	466 s (7m 46s)	13.6%
Ms Matheson	3	7 s	0.2%
Ms Ruttan	0	0 s	0.0%

Turn changes: 202.

PROSODIC MARKERS

Markers are **relative to each speaker's own baseline**, not to each other. `↑/↓ Nst` pitch shift in semitones · `wide`/`flat` F0 range · `fast`/`slow` speech rate · `louder`/`quieter` intensity · (*N.Ns pause*) silence before the turn.

00:00.00 DWYER IC Not just for your interests, but for the efficient administration of justice, which is an overriding consideration that I've got my eye on. And so what I mean by that is that I will endeavour to progress matters as quickly and efficiently as they possibly can be progressed in a way that does not compromise or prejudice people's rights in respect of their case. `flat` And to that end, oftentimes that involves me directing certain things to happen `wide` or declining to allow certain things to happen. And in particular, there is from time to time a tendency to proliferate interlocutory disputes, which delay and complicate the overall resolution `slow 0.8w/s` of a matter. Disclosure disputes can oftentimes be exactly that. They can be an unnecessary and unnecessary distraction that impacts the efficiency of the conduct of proceedings.

(*3.1s pause*) Without specifically being critical of the matters that you are pursuing, in broad terms, there are a number of aspects to the application that you brought that I think are potentially going to impact on the efficiency of the conduct of your proceedings. And so one of the things I hope to achieve in our discussions today, in our discussion `wide` about the matter today, is a different approach that will leave you satisfied that you are not in any way at all compromised in the conduct of your proceedings and that this matter can `flat` get to hearing, which I would assume is your objective and you would like to be at a hearing and you would like to have the question of whether you have sustained a workplace injury `flat` resolved sooner rather than later and I want that for you too and I want that for all the parties and I want that for the people of Queensland who are resourcing these proceedings. I just want to take it back to first principles okay `wide quieter` so that we know where we're at. I'm going to park the non-party disclosure `wide quieter` application for the moment. I'm going to take you back to your statement of facts and contentions. In fact, I'll take you back one step further than that. In general terms, `quieter` as an appellant in proceedings of this type, you have the onus of proving that you have sustained an injury within the meaning of section 32 of the workers' compensation legislation. `flat` legislation. Personal injury arising out of or in the course of your employment where your employment is a significant contributing factor, not excluded by the provisions of Section 32.5, reasonable management action taken in a reasonable way. `↓-2.1st flat` You have placed before the Commission a statement, an amended statement of facts in contentions `wide` and the amended statement of facts and contentions is the framework of your case. It's a hearing de novo, as you know. `flat fast 5.0w/s` It's the framework of your case and it tells the commission and it tells the respondent why you say you meet the requirements in respect of Section 32 and not excluded by Section 32.5. And in particular, you identify what are the stressors that you say are causative of your injury. As in most of these cases, the presence or existence of an injury for the purposes of a medical diagnosis is usually not so much in dispute. dispute. So the real crux of your case is going to be to show that if you have a diagnosis of a psychiatric condition as you do in this particular case, how certain events or things that took place in your workplace caused that, were significant contributors to the cause cause of that condition. Now, in your case, you have identified multiple stressors. You `wide slow 1.1w/s` have broken them down into categories of one, two, three, three different categories and you have broken them down into subcategories under each one of those categories. It's going `wide` going to take us a little bit of time this morning, but I'm hoping that this time in `fast 5.1w/s` me stepping you through these things will put in perspective what types of things will `wide` be relevant to you, are likely to be relevant to you, in proving your case. And in explaining that to you, explaining also what types of things are not relevant to the proving of of your case. And I fully appreciate as a person who's not represented, you may have some difficulty differentiating between relevant and irrelevant. And in fact, it's not at all uncommon to find an unrepresented person with an intense focus on proving certain things that are ultimately, from an objective legal perspective, utterly irrelevant. And it has `wide quieter` been my experience throughout my career that sometimes people in that situation are very very unwillingly disavowed of that view. But that's what I'm going to attempt to do this `flat` morning in terms of stepping through your case and your pleaded stressors and giving `quieter` you examples of how those stressors, how you would address the evidentiary burden in relation to those stressors and how, for example, that has nothing to do with a number of the documents that you are seeking from the health service. Okay, so that's just to set the `quieter` scene in terms of where we're going. Do you have any questions or difficulties understanding all of that `flat` at the moment? No, I mean, you're `quieter` telling me, so I'm not experienced in it, but I just did what I understood. `flat quieter` That's okay. I want to stress, I'm not `↑+4.1st` I'm not being critical of you, Mr Shepherd, but I also need to be very firm in terms of explaining these things to you so that I impress upon you the concern I have with respect to `flat` how this impacts the efficient conduct of the proceedings. `flat`

07:09.36 MR SHEPHERD `wide` I understand, I think I understand, what you think you are trying to achieve and I'm not

07:17.78 DWYER IC `↑+2.1st` saying you are entirely wrong and the thing with disclosure is that if someone's willing to give you some documents you've asked for and they `wide`

07:25.32 MR SHEPHERD don't have any problem with it that's fine I don't have a problem with that

07:29.24 DWYER IC they can give you whatever they want back in the day it was a fairly standard tactic in more commercial types of litigation rather than resist disclosure to send 78 boxes of disclosure to somebody and bury them in paperwork work. So if the health service wants to give you `wide` a truckload of documents for you to sift through, you won't ever get into hearing until 2028 by the time you've worked through all of that. And then you've got to run the gauntlet of whether or not those documents are accepted by the commission into evidence because of their `flat` relevance. So it's one thing to get the documents, it's another thing to get the documents into evidence. So that's the challenges you face in respect of a document document heavy case is that even if some third party is

compelled to or voluntarily provides you with three boxes of documents that go to how many complaints were made by doctors `flat` as to whether the calls were sent to the right person or whatever, all of that, then it still becomes a question of whether or not that's relevant to your case in respect of the matters that you've pleaded as stressors. `flat`

08:36.40 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Well, for me, it wasn't so much. I didn't really matter what's inside those complaints. `flat` it's that they happen to me, if that makes sense. `flat` So that was my point. `↓-2.0st flat fast 4.9w/s` But I wouldn't even need to read them. `flat` Okay. `flat`

08:50.02 DWYER IC Well, perhaps you can explain that to me a bit more clearly because I must confess, *(2.8s pause)* having read the material that you've filed, `wide` it's pretty heavy-going stuff. `wide` Is it AI-assisted, can I ask? `↑+4.1st` Because it feels like it.

09:06.78 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Just to the end. I do it all myself. `flat fast 5.4w/s` well `quieter`

09:11.52 DWYER IC `wide` it feels very AI assisted, now that allegation is thrown around a lot these `flat`

09:18.16 MR SHEPHERD `flat` days and

09:22.08 DWYER IC `flat` often times correctly I don't purport to be an expert in what's AI or what's not AI `flat` but when I read stuff and I start to see terms and language and `flat` complexities of language `flat` that go above and beyond what `flat` you'd anticipate from a human being `flat` even a very intelligent human being I immediately get suspicious about it and AI is look, everyone's got a view about it you can do what you like but I don't respond very well to it `wide` my brain doesn't respond very well to it `flat` because I can't understand half of what I'm reading `flat fast 5.1w/s` it is genuinely incomprehensible `slow 1.0w/s` in some cases and it's not that a sentence doesn't necessarily make sense it just doesn't necessarily make sense in the context of what we're doing here and it's not the most efficient way to communicate your point. The old system of keep it short and sweet, keep it simple. If you want to persuade a court of something, a simple message is always the best. People make the mistake. I've got to have a big case because then it looks more important. You don't have to. `quieter`

10:32.36 MR SHEPHERD I mean for me it happened over a whole year so it's not just one shift `flat`

10:39.24 DWYER IC let me step you through your stressors so I'm looking at your statement of facts and contentions `wide quieter` now this is the document `↑+3.1st` that ultimately in an argument like this around disclosure this is the document that will inform and determine really what's relevant `slow 1.3w/s` and I'm inclined to take a broad approach in terms of things of relevance. You know, if something might ultimately be relevant in a peripheral way, OK, `slow 1.2w/s quieter` well, I won't have an issue with that necessarily. What I'm going to do is, as I said, `↑+2.3st fast 5.8w/s` I'm going to step you through these stressors `fast 5.3w/s` and I'm going to hypothetically lay out for you to the extent that I can to demonstrate to you, `wide` OK, well, this is what you are claiming. `fast 5.2w/s` claiming, how would you go about proving this? And that then hopefully will give you a clearer idea of what is necessary, what's relevant, what kind of documents might be relevant. Okay, I'll just get it underway because otherwise we'll be talking till this afternoon. So I'm looking at, under the heading, the causative stressors. And I'm looking at category Category stressor one, a hostile course of management conduct, reprisal and suppression of rights. Number one, dereliction of, sorry, I should just say, anybody got any objections to me going through this process? It's going to take a little while, but hopefully it'll save us some time and effort down the track.

(4.5s pause) Dereliction of clinical governance. `↑+2.4st louder` Throughout 2023 and 2024, the appellant's line manager, Ms Chloe Taylor, maintained an erratic physical presence and imposed unassessed unilateral directives, either extra-administrative checks paging, without consultation. These arbitrary directives bottlenecked emergency workflows and directly caused verifiable delays to the communication of urgent pathology results to clinical staff. `wide` The appellant's responsible attempts to mitigate these clinical risks triggered the manager's subsequent hostility. `wide` Okay, I'll break it down. `quieter` Ms Chloe Taylor maintained an erratic physical presence how do you propose to prove that `wide` other than your own testimony you'll get in that witness box and you'll say Chloe Taylor had an erratic presence what do you mean by that she was sometimes there, sometimes not there `flat`

13:28.66 MR SHEPHERD correct and that's what I guess access to the room I don't even need to look at them `flat fast 4.8w/s` But access to the hospital itself would tend to prove, or log in to the computer, if she's there or not. That's what I was tending to prove for that. `flat` But it's not, for me it all works together as one big system. So yeah, the data of her coming in and going, and then the data of her logging into the computer as such, would show that, you know, people would... I think I attached one attachment `flat` and it showed that she didn't reply to a complaint about... No, hang on a sec. `↑+3.1st fast 5.4w/s louder` Sorry. `flat`

14:13.96 DWYER IC `↑+3.7st slow 1.3w/s quieter` So her erratic physical presence is something that you can give testimony about. And I don't want you to do that now, `flat fast 5.8w/s` which is what you're launching into. `flat` But so one way you'll prove that is that I worked there between 2023 and 2024. in my observation, Chloe Taylor had an erratic presence. What do you mean by that, Mr Sheppard? Well, she was there some days, she was there not some days. `wide` She showed up in the morning and left in the afternoon. `flat fast 5.8w/s` She was there in the afternoon but not in the morning. `fast 5.8w/s` Is that what you mean by erratic presence? `wide`

14:48.62 MR SHEPHERD `wide` Exactly.

14:49.42 DWYER IC `↑+2.9st` Okay, so you can give that evidence. And it's for the regulator to contradict that. If that's your evidence and you put it here in your statement of facts and contentions. `flat` And no doubt, at some point, I'm not sure whether we've got to the exchange of outlines of evidence, but that's your evidence. She had an erratic presence. `flat` That was based on your observation. `flat fast 4.8w/s` That's your evidence. `flat` If the regulator wants to dispute that, they can dispute it. `wide` No doubt they may have Ms Taylor on their witness list or not.

(2.2s pause) It's often thrown out there as an appellant that you have the onus of proving your case, and that's true, but the regulator does have to contradict things that you say. It's not the same thing as an onus, but if you say something and it's not contradicted, then the likelihood is it's not guaranteed, but `wide quieter` there's a likelihood that it'll be accepted. So your evidence is she had an erratic presence. What do you mean by that, Mr. Sheppard? Well, this, and you explain what that is. `wide`

(3.3s pause) imposed unassessed unilateral directives. `flat` How did she impose unassessed unilateral directives?

16:06.92 MR SHEPHERD `wide` So, for instance, without consulting any of the staff members?

16:11.06 DWYER IC `↑+2.1st` Well, first of all, first of all, was this done by... How did she do it? By email? Are these things in writing?

16:18.90 MR SHEPHERD Yeah, so that was what I was requesting, email. But I said that... `flat`

16:23.08 DWYER IC But don't you request that from... Couldn't you request that from the regulator?

(2.9s pause)

16:29.72 MR SHEPHERD `flat` I guess I did request, but I didn't be specific about that.

(2.4s pause)

16:37.02 DWYER IC Um, so you say, and perhaps it's a question of particulars, you say, um, imposed, unassessed unilateral directives. Do you mean by that, and tell me if I've got this wrong, that she sent emails in the form of a directive to staff?

16:55.94 MR SHEPHERD `flat quieter` Correct.

16:56.22 DWYER IC `slow 1.0w/s quieter` Okay. So, in light of that pleading, wouldn't you be at liberty to ask the regulator to produce those documents? `flat` I've just asked MSH. I thought that's who holds the documents. `quieter` Yes. Well, Ms Matheson, has disclosure in respect of documents taken place over the course of the matter so far? `wide`

17:35.36 MS MATHESON `wide` Yes, Commissioner. We've disclosed all we have currently.

17:38.96 DWYER IC Okay. Does that include email communications from Ms Chloe Taylor to staff?

17:45.20 MR SHEPHERD `↑+3.3st quieter` There has been some emails to involve the quality of the staff, but I have to probably consider that. `flat quieter`

17:53.42 DWYER IC `flat` Okay. Have you examined those documents that have been disclosed to you, Mr Shepherd, to see whether or not it contains examples of these unassessed unilateral directives?

18:03.48 MR SHEPHERD `flat` They do not. They're more just isolated towards me.

(2.0s pause)

18:09.88 DWYER IC So do you say that in the disclosure that has occurred so far there have been nothing that represents an example of what you call an unassessed unilateral directive from Chloe Taylor? `flat` You say there's nothing like that in what's been disclosed to you from the regulator? `↓-2.2st flat`

18:29.00 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Not that I can recall, no. Okay. `quieter`

18:31.60 DWYER IC `quieter` Okay. You see, making an order for a third party to disclose documents is a step sort of beyond what normally happens in disclosure. It's quite an imposition because the health service is not a party to these proceedings. They're not party to this. They're not involved in these proceedings apart from the consequences of the application you file today. The starting point is to ask the regulator to produce those documents. Have you done that? `quieter` I have asked the regulator to produce what they have. `quieter` Have you asked them to produce the unassessed unilateral directives? Not those specific things, no. `flat` Okay. Well that would be a starting point. That's assuming that, because the regulator `wide quieter` whilst not representing the health service will have access to the health service. That necessarily will need to call potentially people `wide` who work for the health service as witnesses in the case, potentially. Maybe not, but maybe. `quieter`

(2.3s pause) In any event, the starting point for documents that you say exist `wide` that haven't been produced is the regulator. You haven't specifically asked them for that. `flat`

19:45.62 MR SHEPHERD `flat` No, it was my understanding that I asked the person and that control of the documents. `flat` Okay. `↓-2.4st flat`

19:51.22 DWYER IC And perhaps I'm getting into stuff you haven't even complained about. But the point is, Mr. Sheppard, `wide` is that just looking at number... `wide` Stressor 1A, `wide` the way in which you prove this, `↑+3.2st` if you were going to prove this, `flat fast 5.7w/s` is you would give evidence `flat` about the erratic movements of Chloe Taylor and then you would produce documentary evidence of the unassessed unilateral directives as you describe them. `wide`

(4.0s pause) and that's the starting point. `↑+2.7st flat quieter` So, Chloe Taylor's here erratically `↑+2.1st` and she gives us these unassessed directives. OK, so you give evidence that she's there erratically and you produce the documents that are examples. `wide` How do you get those? `flat fast 5.0w/s` Well, the first thing you do is you see what the regulator's disclosed and then if they haven't disclosed it, you write to them and say, `wide fast 5.8w/s` see, here I refer to unassessed unilateral directives. I can recall on about July 2023 a directive to the effect of this. That document should be in your possession or control and I want you to make inquiries and produce it to me. And if they don't, well, then you go to your non-party disclosure. I'm not sure that these documents form part of your

non-party disclosure from recollection. `wide` It's a pretty wide net you're casting, but I'm not sure you've actually asked for emails from Chloe Taylor `wide` tailor to the staff in respective directives. `wide`

(8.4s pause) Where do I find that in your application? And this is the other difficulty in respect of the... `wide fast 5.1w/s louder`

21:29.20 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Could I give you a simplified... I gave it a mistake. `flat fast 4.8w/s` But it's just a... It's really, really simple.

21:34.88 DWYER IC `↑+3.4st` It should have been simple the first time. Because when it's not simple, I'll tell you right now, `↑+2.4st` and I don't mind saying this, `wide` when I'm overloaded with page after page after page after page `wide` of what looks like AI generated material I switch off I'm a human being too Mr Shepherd and my brain doesn't process it `↑+2.5st wide` and so what happens amongst all of that is I miss the point that's how I fall into error `↑+3.2st flat louder` if you give me way too much `↑+3.8st` if you talk at me for two hours `↑+4.2st wide` about something you can tell me in two minutes `flat fast 5.0w/s` I'm going to miss the point `wide quieter` Like any other human being.

22:11.82 MR SHEPHERD `↑+4.1st fast 4.9w/s` Can I give you these two pieces of paper?

22:13.82 DWYER IC `wide fast 5.9w/s` Hand it up, please.

(10.4s pause) What am I looking at? `↑+3.0st fast 5.0w/s` You've seen this, I take it, Ms Matheson? `flat`

22:29.58 MS MATHESON `↓-2.0st` Only just now.

22:31.40 MR SHEPHERD `↑+2.4st wide` I haven't got a copy, but I can share.

22:34.70 DWYER IC `fast 6.4w/s` If you don't mind, I'm just going to look at it and see where it takes us. If I think you need to be across it, I'll let you know. `fast 5.0w/s` What am I looking at, Mr Sheppard? `wide`

22:42.12 MR SHEPHERD `flat` The 20 questions of my request of disclosure. So the 20... `wide`

22:50.64 DWYER IC `fast 5.7w/s louder` This is the simple version, is it?

22:51.96 MR SHEPHERD Yes.

22:53.46 DWYER IC Where's the bit about Chloe Taylor's unassessed unilateral directives? So just say email directives, basically. `flat` Where's that? `flat quieter`

(16.0s pause)

23:19.06 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Manager, email, filters, that's what it would be, it would be under there.

23:23.98 DWYER IC `wide` Which heading, which page, what number?

23:26.28 MR SHEPHERD 10.

23:27.98 DWYER IC Item 10?

23:29.16 MR SHEPHERD `↓-3.0st wide quieter` 10.

23:30.16 DWYER IC `flat` Manager, email, filters, A to E.

23:33.48 MR SHEPHERD `flat` The filters would be directives.

23:37.28 DWYER IC `↑+3.6st` What does filters mean?

23:40.12 MR SHEPHERD When you go into, let's say, e-health, for instance, or let's say Outlook, `flat` and you put a word in Outlook `flat` and it filters all the words. So my filters were effective immediately. So that would be a filter. So they get all these emails and say effective immediately. Absolutely. Does that make sense? So that's the directives. And I basically just want `wide` the count. I don't even, for me, it doesn't matter.

24:12.02 DWYER IC `↑+2.9st` Can I just, I don't mean to, I'm not picking on you, Mr. Sheppardson. I just want you to, sorry, Mr. Sheppard. Let's just look at line 10, okay? So under the heading, disposition `wide` of items in brackets, single table. Okay? Doesn't make any sense to me. Disposition `quieter` of items, as in this is what you want me to do with the items contained in your non-party disclosure, and then we go to line 10, status, press. What does press mean?

24:43.10 MR SHEPHERD `flat` I would say...

24:44.60 DWYER IC `↑+2.2st fast 6.1w/s louder` Press this, or what do I do?

24:46.18 MR SHEPHERD To either swear it or produce it.

24:50.06 DWYER IC `wide` So you press, so you're still pressing for disclosure of manager email filters A-E.

24:59.12 MR SHEPHERD A. Yeah, A to A, which is on form 29.

(25.6s pause)

25:27.40 DWYER IC `flat quieter` This is the Form 29 file on the 22nd of April, 2025, 26, yeah. `wide`

(16.8s pause) A, C, E, what's that a reference to? `flat quieter`

(2.0s pause)

25:55.04 MR SHEPHERD `flat` A, B, C, D, E, which is number 10.

(15.8s pause)

26:13.98 DWYER IC `↑+2.7st` manager email filters

(2.9s pause) I still don't understand what filters `quieter` means, is this filtered by `wide` language, is that what you're saying? `flat fast 4.8w/s`

26:23.84 MR SHEPHERD yeah, so effective immediately or for this now or anything like that `wide`

26:29.48 DWYER IC `wide fast 5.4w/s louder` A through to E.

26:30.40 MR SHEPHERD Yeah. Okay. `flat`

(3.4s pause)

26:34.76 DWYER IC `wide quieter` You see, in a hearing, if you forget all these, right, forget all these documents that you want to produce to prove that she sent you these emails. `flat` So first of all, let me just come back to your statement of stressors, right?

26:52.54 MR SHEPHERD Unassessed unilateral directives. Okay.

26:54.90 DWYER IC She's your manager, right?

26:56.34 MR SHEPHERD `flat quieter` Yep.

26:56.86 DWYER IC `wide` So she's going to send you directions. unilaterally. Anyway, you can be directed as an employee to do certain things, right? What do you mean by unassessed?

27:06.64 MR SHEPHERD What does unassessed mean? Unassessed would be that she wasn't even in the room or she doesn't even enter the room to see what's going on and makes a decision `flat` without any input of the staff. Like a manager? `flat` I mean, usually a manager would need input. `flat`

27:22.96 DWYER IC Like a manager. Managers make decisions without consulting staff up all the time. It's totally legitimate. `flat`

27:28.90 MR SHEPHERD `flat fast 4.7w/s` But I think when it's in a patient safety environment that they `flat`

27:32.64 DWYER IC If you think it's in a patient safety environment you can raise that. `wide` Anyway, let's not get into the case. `↑+3.0st` So let's just pretend none of this exists `↑+3.1st` and you're here in the witness box and you've `flat` got this stressor. `flat`

27:44.52 MR SHEPHERD `↑+4.1st` She's erratic physical presence and `slow 0.9w/s` imposes unassessed unilateral directives. `↓-2.1st flat`

27:52.44 DWYER IC `wide` You can give that evidence. You can say and she gave us these directives. All all the time, never asked us anything, she just kept sending these emails through saying `↑+3.6st`

27:59.66 MR SHEPHERD `↑+2.7st` effective immediately we're going to do this, effective immediately we're going to do that.

28:04.00 DWYER IC You can say that. Now, I don't know necessarily whether I haven't checked the regulator's statement of facts and contentions in any great detail. `flat` They may wish to contradict that. They may not want to contradict that. They might say the manager sent emails giving directions to staff. Here's an example of one. and the argument might not be about whether you received emails from Ms Taylor the argument might be about whether or not they're correctly categorised by you `wide` as unassessed directives made without consultation `flat` you've placed subjectively a characterisation on these emails `↑+2.4st` which may be contradicted `quieter` but the existence of the emails may not be in dispute as far as I can tell So you don't need the emails to prove that the emails are unassessed directives, necessarily. And if you give evidence that you were sent unassessed directives by Ms Taylor, as you `↑+2.1st` call them, and the regulator doesn't contradict it, doesn't cross-examine you, doesn't produce `quieter` documents for you to comment on and that sort of thing, well, you know, that's a problem for them, not for you.

29:17.88 MR SHEPHERD `flat` so for me it was direct calls to this number `↑+3.0st` but this number is an emergency contact and then those doctors the ones that get called for an emergency `flat` they're sent to the wrong side of the room they're not sent to someone having a cardiac arrest they're not sent to someone in respiratory distress `flat` we're now not even contacting them by their numbers

(5.7s pause)

29:45.62 DWYER IC It's going to move on for a moment, okay? Because after my speech about efficiency of conduct of proceedings, I'm concerned at the direction this is going in, Mr Shepherd. `flat` And ultimately what I'm proposing is if we can't work this out today, if you can't get `↑+3.2st` yourself to a point where you're satisfied with the approach, a different approach or or a more practical approach, `flat` or a more cohesive and cooperative approach `↑+2.3st` with the parties that are sitting at the other end of the table. `flat fast 5.8w/s`

✓ **AMENDMENT A1 — speaker re-attributed. Confidence: 100% (participant).**

The following interjection was originally labelled DWYER IC. It is **MR SHEPHERD**, confirmed 16 September 2026 by Mr Shepherd, who was present and who states the words are his.

Purpose stated by the speaker: an acknowledgement of the Commissioner's point, spoken as a **preface to explaining his disclosure request**. It conveyed **neither acceptance nor rejection** of the approach the Commissioner was proposing. The explanation did not follow: the Commissioner speaks over it and completes his sentence.

30:12.98 MR SHEPHERD ✓ (amended A1 — 100%, participant-confirmed; ✓ independently corroborated by ECAPA diarisation)

Yeah, I actually understand what you're getting at. `wide`

DWYER IC (continuing, interrupting) If we can't get to that, `↑+5.9st fast 6.4w/s louder` I'm going to schedule this disclosure dispute for a hearing.

30:19.46 MR SHEPHERD Yeah.

30:20.06 DWYER IC And the health service is going to need to call evidence to talk to their objections, `wide` and the regulator may or may not have anything to say, but in the meantime, the party should work very hard `↑+2.4st` at formulating a bundle of documents that might satisfy you. I don't know to what extent that's happened so far. I see a very comprehensive objection, `wide louder` but what the responsibility of the parties is when you have a disclosure dispute like this `wide` is to get working on whether they can resolve it without my intervention. `flat` That's what the parties need to be doing as well. `fast 5.0w/s` I don't know whether that's happened or not `flat` or whether it's just a, this is what I want, `wide` no, you can't have it. `flat fast 5.8w/s` If that's where we're at, well, you've got a bit of work `fast 6.3w/s` to do down there at the bar table. `↓-2.3st flat fast 6.0w/s` But if we can't reach some understanding today `wide` day where you can be disavowed of the need to extract thousands of documents from the health service then we're going to need to have a hearing and i need to decide whether you're entitled to do `flat fast 5.5w/s` that or whether it's unreasonable for you for you to require the health service or ask the health `flat` service to do that i can't do that in a mention this morning and i can't do that based on on the papers i'm going to need to hear evidence about what's involved and that's going to have cost consequences as well because i'd imagine the health service will probably want to engage `flat` aged ground law and they'll bring their lawyers along and I'll allow that because this is `wide` a complicated matter potentially if you want it to be and then there'll be cost consequences. That's a hearing that's probably going to go longer than a day because there's a lot of items in your list and lots of sub-items in your list, you know, A to E and 10 alone. So, yeah, this is going to be a big sideshow, probably bigger than the hearing at the end `↑+2.1st` of the day and if you want it, you can have it. `wide`

32:02.78 MR SHEPHERD `↑+2.5st` I think I can understand where you're getting at `flat` I think I can meet most of the way, I understand how `flat`

32:10.84 DWYER IC Have you had discussions with the `wide` regulator about what they can and can't facilitate in respect of disclosure for documents that you say `flat` they could have or should `quieter` have, have you had `quieter`

32:24.58 MR SHEPHERD constructive discussions with them? We have not `wide fast 5.6w/s` not like a constructive discussion (3.5s pause) I haven't been specific because I thought I had to go to MSH for, so. `flat`

(2.4s pause)

32:43.46 DWYER IC I don't know whether it's a generational thing, but back in my day we used to pick up the phone and we would talk to people and we'd say, hey, and just because you're an opponent to somebody in litigation doesn't mean you can't have a constructive civil conversation with them, right? Even if you're self-represented. it. And it could be that all of this could be sorted out in a couple of constructive `quieter` phone calls. But before I release you to do that, I just want to bring you back to the `quieter` statement of stressors, right? I see that you've attempted to identify relevance in `wide` in terms of your response to the objection in relation to it, `quieter` and your application as well. `flat`

(4.0s pause) But it's not at all unheard of. `wide quieter` In fact, it's more common than not `flat` that appellants will give evidence in these proceedings `flat` without relying heavily on documentary case, not suggesting that you should or shouldn't. `wide` But if you were, as an appellant, `wide slow 1.3w/s quieter` to get in the witness box and say Miss Chloe Taylor had an erratic `wide` presence and she kept sending us these emails and where are the emails Mr Sheppard? Well I asked the regulator I said there will be examples and they haven't been provided and then if I was presiding on the matter I'd say Miss Matheson have you got any emails `wide` of that type and they'll say we asked but none were provided to us `wide` and then I've got to decide whether or not I accept your evidence or not but they don't contradict it, but more often than not, if you alleged that there were emails that were causative of your stress, I would have thought the regulator would be all over that and they'd say, right, well let's have a look at them, what do you mean by `fast 5.8w/s` that? And then they'd get examples of them and they would find their way into evidence.

34:38.54 MR SHEPHERD `wide` Anyway.

(4.1s pause)

34:43.08 DWYER IC Unilateral destruction of work health and safety records. On the 6th of June, the appellant recorded a critical operation and instruction in the communication book regarding the necessity of updating medical `flat` on-call contact numbers. Ms Taylor unilaterally removed and destroyed this entry. When questioned, Ms Taylor subjected the appellant to a hostile and verbally aggressive reprimand. You're not going to need documents for that, are you? That's just going to be, you're going `wide fast 5.4w/s` to make that assertion in your evidence and I would have thought the regulator will call Ms Taylor to give her side of the story and you'll get to cross-examine Ms Taylor. So you don't need any documents for that, do you?

35:21.08 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Well, they've got documents for it, so...

35:23.76 DWYER IC `louder` Okay, so have they disclosed those to you?

35:26.56 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Yes. She took them out. `flat` What have they disclosed to you? `flat fast 5.0w/s` I guess a dispute about the event, but it was taken out. That's it.

35:37.98 DWYER IC `flat` So she's agreed it was taken out?

35:40.40 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Yes. I mean, it wasn't ever said to me. It was said to...

35:44.20 DWYER IC `flat` Okay.

35:44.88 MR SHEPHERD `↓-2.9st` Yeah, so...

35:45.72 DWYER IC In any event, it sounds like there's going to be a dispute around the characterisation of that event. Did she unilaterally destroy work health and safety records `flat` in a way that was perhaps inappropriate in your view?

36:02.34 MR SHEPHERD `louder` Or not?

36:03.12 DWYER IC `wide` And she'll give evidence about that. There's no documents required for that, is there? `wide` Did she physically tear the page out of a book? Yes, she tore it. `↓-2.2st wide quieter` So maybe the book. `flat fast 5.0w/s` book. So we can see the torn out page. But she might admit she tore it out, in which `quieter` case we probably don't need the book. But anyway, that's the matter. It's not a particularly `wide` document heavy point, that one. Refusal to investigate work health and safety fatigue complaints. Did you make a health and safety fatigue complaint in writing?

(2.0s pause) Yes, I made many. Okay. So you'll have a copy, or there should be a copy of an email to that effect? `fast 6.4w/s louder`

36:42.26 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Some of those emails, but my health service email was restricted. `flat`

36:46.62 DWYER IC Okay, but you've identified that on the 7th of August, 2023, `flat` you submitted a formal grievance. That's in the form of an email. `fast 6.5w/s`

36:52.92 MR SHEPHERD Yep. Do you still have a copy of that? `fast 6.2w/s` I have a copy of that. `fast 8.3w/s` So that's in your documentary case. `flat`

36:57.44 DWYER IC `flat` You've got that document. And Ms. Taylor's conduct specifically raised `flat` is blah, blah, blah, and you said, `flat fast 5.9w/s` said, Miss Tammy Rees dismissed the complaint the same day without formal investigation and directed the appellant to continue reporting directly to Miss Taylor. Did Miss Tammy Rees

37:16.98 MR SHEPHERD do that in an email or a letter? I wrote that to an email and that was our email correspondence back of course. Yes, I got that. And you've got that? Yeah. Done. You've got your documents `wide` for that stressor. `flat`

37:29.56 DWYER IC `wide` Disparate treatment and statutory leave obstruction, COVID. Between 20 February and 1 March 2024, Ms Taylor forced the actively ill appellant `wide` to self-administer COVID-19 special pandemic leave via MyHR, `flat slow 0.8w/s` a facilitation she routinely exercised directly for other staff. `flat` The system server logs timestamp the appellant's successful upload at exactly 11.41am on 20 February 2024. So you've been very specific about that. Despite the subjective system log, Ms Taylor capriciously declined the application twice, advancing factually erroneous claims contradicted by objective server logs. So in essence you were ill and you were seeking to take leave `wide` in relation to COVID and you say that `wide` Ms. Taylor capriciously declined your application `flat` twice. Did she decline it via email? `wide`

38:31.96 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Well, she actually declined it on the phone and then declined it on the MyHR twice. Okay.

38:38.90 DWYER IC But that's all, I have all that. You've got all that? Okay, tick. Public interest disclosure on the 13th of May 2024 lodged a corrupt conduct complaint regarding clinical risks. It's Ethical Standards Unit formally determined this constituted a public interest disclosure. `flat` Got all the documents for that? `flat`

(2.2s pause) No, that's reform 29. So presumably you lodged a corrupt conduct complaint. `wide` You'll have a copy of that because it's your document. `flat`

39:08.54 MR SHEPHERD Yeah.

39:09.18 DWYER IC `flat` And the Ethical Standards Unit formally determined it constituted a public interest disclosure. `flat` You got a letter back confirming that. So there you go. `flat quieter`

39:18.08 MR SHEPHERD The point was that what, stress me out, was what action was taken when HR received that complaint. `flat`

39:26.38 DWYER IC Okay, so that's your next item. That's F. `wide` So in relation to stressor E, you've included the fact that you lodged a corrupt conduct complaint and it was determined that it constituted a PID. So you've got your documents in relation to that. The next one is the immediate reprisal. `wide` Within 48 hours of the PID being lodged, Ms Rees directed the appellant to retract a routine workplace email. `flat` A highly comparable email sent by Ms Taylor attracted no such discipline. So presumably within, so sometime around the 15th of May 2024, `wide` Ms Rees has given you a direction to retract a routine workplace email. `flat` How did she give you that direction? `flat` Is it in the form of an email? `fast 6.3w/s`

40:13.04 MR SHEPHERD She said that I have no longer got those. Is it in the form of an email? `flat fast 6.6w/s louder`

40:18.44 DWYER IC `flat` Yes, but I've no longer got those. But you've got, sorry? `flat fast 4.9w/s` I was restricted in my... `flat` First of all, answer my question first. `↑+3.3st` Is it in the form of an email? `fast 6.3w/s` Yes or no? `flat quieter`

40:28.28 MR SHEPHERD Yes.

40:28.64 DWYER IC `flat` Have you got that email?

40:29.94 MR SHEPHERD `flat fast 6.9w/s` No, I do not. All right. `flat fast 6.2w/s`

40:31.54 DWYER IC `wide` Ms. Matheson, have you got that email? You don't know? `flat quieter`

40:36.74 MS MATHESON `↑+2.4st wide` The request for conducting an email,

40:40.42 MR SHEPHERD `↑+3.2st flat quieter` I do believe we have those, and I do believe we've disclosed them. `flat quieter`

40:45.04 DWYER IC So it'll be an email from Ms Rees to Mr Sheppard on or about 15 May 2024, `flat` the effect of which is purported to be a direction `flat quieter` to retract an email that he has sent. `flat`

41:01.20 MR SHEPHERD `↑+4.1st wide` I do believe that I have received those, Commissioner, and disclosed them. `quieter` I would have to triple check to be... `↑+2.9st quieter`

41:07.98 DWYER IC `↑+3.1st` That's okay. That's all right.

41:10.38 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Sorry, there's more emails which I don't

41:14.42 DWYER IC there's a conversation. I'll come back to that in a moment we'll come back to the more emails in a moment. So the stressor `wide` you're relying on there, and I understand the case you're making `wide` so you put in a PID and then within 48 hours Ms Rees says to you `wide` retract an email you've sent. And so `wide` you've got the email from Ms Rees telling you to retract an email

41:37.54 MR SHEPHERD `↑+6.7st` Correct.

41:38.74 DWYER IC `flat` And you've, have you got the email that she asked you to retract?

41:43.64 MR SHEPHERD Yes, I got those two.

41:45.98 DWYER IC Okay, you've got that. And you, so you've got in essence the documents that support that allegation.

41:53.82 MR SHEPHERD `quieter` Yep.

41:55.02 DWYER IC You've got your PID on the 13th of May. You've got on the 15th of May an email from Ms Rees saying retract this email that you sent. and you've got a copy of the email that she was referring to. `flat`

(2.4s pause) Your case then tilts into a comparison. `wide` You say that a highly comparable email sent by Ms Taylor `wide` attracted no such discipline. `flat` Well, firstly, do you have a copy of the email from Ms Taylor that you're comparing to yours?

42:25.34 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Correct, yes.

42:25.90 DWYER IC `fast 5.4w/s louder` You do? All right. And where does your knowledge come from that you rely on to say `flat` Ms. Taylor wasn't subject to the same direction or discipline?

(3.9s pause)

42:42.42 MR SHEPHERD `flat` I don't have knowledge of that, but it seemed pretty... `flat` I understood it. `flat` Okay. `flat`

42:47.96 DWYER IC So your evidence is going to be that Ms. Taylor sent the same sort of email and nothing happened to her. `flat fast 4.9w/s`

42:53.60 MR SHEPHERD `↓-5.3st quieter` Yeah. Okay, but you don't know... `↑+2.4st wide` I don't know that. `fast 5.6w/s` ...to a certainty. `↑+2.4st wide`

42:57.44 DWYER IC `fast 5.1w/s` And that's a question you can put to Ms. Taylor.

42:59.54 MR SHEPHERD `↓-10.7st quieter` Yeah.

42:59.90 DWYER IC `flat` and you don't need any other documents for that. So there you go. `flat fast 6.9w/s` You've got the documents that you need for those stressors. G, suppression of industrial representation `wide` during roster disputes. `flat` In April 2023, the appellant formally expressed interest `wide` in assuming the role of union delegate. In direct contravention of union encouragement,

(2.1s pause) the employer actively suppressed this appointment for 13 months. `wide` months. Okay, so in April 2023, you formally expressed interest in assuming the role of `quieter`

43:36.16 MR SHEPHERD `wide` union delegate, in an email I presume? Yeah, even in when I went for, when I went from point A to full time as well, so even in an application. `flat fast 4.8w/s`

43:45.82 DWYER IC Okay. And so there might be some oral testimony that goes with this, but there's presumably, when you say formally expressed interest, I presume that's a reference to something in writing? Yep, there's a few things. And you've got that? Yep. Okay. So then you contend that the employer actively suppressed your appointment as a union rep for 13 months. Crucially `wide` this deliberate administrative inaction left the department operating without local delegate representation precisely during a period when the `flat` appellant was actively attempting to dispute unsafe time rostering `flat` etc. etc. So how do you say that that they actively suppressed your appointment for 13 months? `flat` Like, what did they do? `fast 5.0w/s`

44:27.90 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Because the union said that they've emailed my manager.

44:31.60 DWYER IC So the union said that they have emailed your manager?

44:34.92 MR SHEPHERD `fast 4.7w/s` I got that in writing, yes. OK, you've got that letter? `wide` Yep. `↑+2.4st flat quieter`

44:38.38 DWYER IC `flat` And so it says something to the effect of, we've been emailing your manager, `flat louder` but we haven't heard back from them, or they're not cooperating, or whatever. `flat` Yeah, just that we've followed up with the health service, or we've followed up with the manager, `flat fast 5.2w/s` and, yeah, it was just ongoing. `flat quieter` Can I just, as an aside, make the observation

here `wide` that I've had a lot of experience with unions over my career and if they had a person who they were putting forward as their workplace delegate `flat` and they weren't getting cooperation from management `flat` about the installation of that person as the workplace, in a formal sense, `flat` they wouldn't sit on it for 13 months. Are you saying that they did? `flat fast 6.2w/s`

45:21.08 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Yeah, so I joined a second union.

45:23.66 DWYER IC `flat` So you joined another union?

45:25.16 MR SHEPHERD Exactly. Okay. `↑+3.7st flat`

45:26.48 DWYER IC `↑+3.4st wide slow 1.3w/s quieter` So, well, it just seems unusual to me, Mr. Shepard, and I'm not going to get into the facts now `fast 6.2w/s` because I'm not hearing the matter, `flat fast 5.7w/s` but your evidence about the employer inactivity `slow 1.1w/s` or the employer, you say, actively suppressed this appointment. appointment. So deliberately, consciously interfered with your taking office as their `wide` workplace delegate. Is that what you're saying? `flat` We didn't have one. `fast 5.9w/s` No, no, no, no. It's a simple question. Your case, as you said here, is the employer actively `↑+3.0st` suppressed the appointment for 13 months. So actively means they deliberately. Am I `wide` right about that or have I read that wrong? `fast 5.1w/s louder`

46:10.84 MR SHEPHERD ✓ (confirmed A2 — 100%, participant-confirmed) I don't know if I can prove it as much.

46:13.64 DWYER IC `quieter` Okay. Well, that answers the question. So your case, but it doesn't mean you can't make the case. `↑+4.5st` I'm not saying to you you can't run the case, `wide fast 6.2w/s` but I'm focusing here on what you can prove and can't prove, but more particularly, if you have to prove `wide quieter` or you think you can prove something, `wide fast 6.7w/s` whether there's a document that supports it. `flat` So you don't have any documents, or sorry, `↑+3.4st` the employer, to your knowledge, `wide` doesn't have any documents that demonstrate `flat` that they actively suppress the appointment. `flat` moment, it's more so the correspondence you got from the union. `flat`

46:44.90 MR SHEPHERD `↑+2.8st` The correspondence I also got from the manager, but it wasn't actively spread, it was actively avoided, but would be more likely. `flat`

46:52.06 DWYER IC Okay, but in any event, your characterisation of the conduct of the employer in relation to this stressor is based on the fact that you put your hand up formally to be the union union delegate, and 13 months went by, and you were not formally installed as the union delegate in any formal way? `wide`

47:15.68 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Well, it was just time and time again, so it wasn't just 30 months, it was documented time and time again, I was attempted. `flat` Okay. `flat`

47:22.84 DWYER IC So have you got your correspondence between you and the union?

47:26.80 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Yes, I got both, my manager and my union, but yeah.

47:30.48 DWYER IC So you got all the correspondence that demonstrates that it was 13 months? you've got all of that? I just haven't got what the manager did with that correspondence if that makes sense. Do you know that they did anything with it? Well I think they didn't do anything with it Do you know they did anything with it? Well I didn't What are you asking for if that's the case? Do you think there is some

47:55.66 MR SHEPHERD I'm asking for evidence or a sworn statement to say that I guess they didn't do anything with it `flat`

48:02.56 DWYER IC So your case is going to be, based on the documents that I understand you've got now, is that you formally put your hand up to be the union delegate and that via communications from one of two unions in a 13-month period following that, there was no steps taken or recognition of your office being assumed as a union delegate in that 13-month period. period and you're informed that management had some role in that through correspondence from your union. `flat`

48:36.74 MR SHEPHERD Correct. Okay. `↑+2.2st flat`

48:37.76 DWYER IC `↑+2.1st fast 6.2w/s louder` And you can put all that in evidence.

(2.7s pause) When I say that, I'm not making a ruling on that now for the purposes of the final hearing, so there may be some objection to correspondence from a union that's not supported by a testimony `flat` from the author of the correspondence, but if it's a letter to you, you can say, I've

48:57.04 MR SHEPHERD `wide` I got this letter from the union, and the letter says the management is blocking me.

49:03.58 DWYER IC `flat` You know, management's not being very helpful. But as I said, I come back to my aside. `wide fast 5.6w/s` It's unusual, in my experience, that a union wouldn't have, you know, gone to town on that. `wide` Well, they just said that we emailed the health service. `flat`

49:19.58 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Yeah, they didn't really do much. But that's why I ended up joining a second unit, a union at the time, `flat` because there was a lot of inconsistency there.

49:29.32 DWYER IC `flat fast 5.0w/s` And how did the second union go with having you put in as the union delegate? `flat`

49:33.46 MR SHEPHERD `flat` Well, second union, they basically... I can't remember the...

49:40.20 DWYER IC `↑+3.3st flat fast 6.8w/s louder` Yes or no? Mr Sheppard, did they support your appointment `↑+4.2st louder` as the union delegate representing their union? `flat`

49:46.14 MR SHEPHERD `flat` They did not cover the administration.

49:50.06 DWYER IC So they didn't have coverage of that workplace?

49:53.18 MR SHEPHERD Yeah.

49:53.36 DWYER IC So you couldn't be a representative of that union in that workplace? Okay. All right. `wide quieter` Okay, so I don't know that there's a lot of documents `↑+2.4st quieter` beyond what you've already got that support that contention. `flat` And remember that disclosure's not like an exercise of phishing. You can't go sort of delving around at large in the inboxes and so forth. You make the assertion here. `wide` Once you've made the assertion, the regulator's got to respond to it. `wide` They've got to address it. They'll address it in cross-examination. They may produce documents that they seek to rely on to contradict it. They've got to disclose those documents to you. So you've got the documents that support that contention, or that stressor, it would read to me. `wide`

(2.2s pause) We go to stressor two, `↑+2.8st` systematic failure to discharge remuneration obligations between February and April 2024. The employer systematically failed to pay the appellant whose correct statutory entitlement `flat` is resulting in a documented 42% pay disparity. `flat`

(2.2s pause) Can I just say as an aside, `↑+2.2st quieter` has that been the subject of an unpaid wages claim `flat` or has your pay disparity been rectified?

51:09.18 MR SHEPHERD `flat` I have not raised that.

51:11.72 DWYER IC So you haven't raised a 42% pay disparity? I haven't raised it with the QARC or anything. 42% pay disparity `↑+4.6st flat` meaning what? You paid 42% under `flat` what you should be paying? Is that what you're saying? `fast 6.0w/s`

51:24.60 MR SHEPHERD That's what me and my colleagues over a six week

51:26.94 DWYER IC `wide` period. Over a six week period you and your colleagues were underpaid `flat` in the amount of 42% `flat` of what they should have been paid `flat fast 5.6w/s`

51:35.28 MR SHEPHERD So I guess over public holidays and things `↑+5.2st flat louder` my manager decided to roster me on different specific days `flat` and it ends up being `wide` 42% difference `flat` In what? Between me and my colleague.

51:50.00 DWYER IC `louder` Between you and a colleague or your colleagues generally?

51:52.84 MR SHEPHERD `flat` My colleagues generally because I would be rostered off.

51:55.06 DWYER IC Okay, so somewhere in the rostering system you didn't get public holidays and therefore you didn't get the loading for public holidays. Is that what you're saying? `flat fast 6.4w/s`

52:04.86 MR SHEPHERD It was a consistent theme, yes.

52:07.00 DWYER IC `quieter` Okay, all right. And you'd prove that presumably through a sample of rosters between February and April 2024, wouldn't you? `flat` or the rosters. So you're saying this stress all particularly relies on evidence around what the rostering was `flat` in respect of public holidays between February and April 2024. So those public holidays would be Good Friday, `flat` Easter Sunday, Easter Monday and `wide` Anzac Day. So four public holidays. So `flat quieter`

(2.3s pause) So have you got access to the rosters for that period? `flat`

52:46.46 MR SHEPHERD `fast 5.5w/s` I have all the evidence for that.

52:47.86 DWYER IC `wide quieter` Got all those? Awesome. So your theory is going to be look at the rostering in relation to me, look at the rostering in relation to other staff members in that three-month period.

53:00.52 MR SHEPHERD `↓-6.8st flat quieter` Yes. Okay. `flat`

53:02.86 DWYER IC `flat louder` Is there any other document that you say you know exists which tends to support that you were deliberately `flat` rostered in a way that avoided you being put on public `flat` holidays? There's probably a few `wide slow 1.2w/s quieter` things yes. Well probably or is because disclosure is about what you know `wide`

53:22.68 MR SHEPHERD I think I actually said that I'm not asking disclosure about that anymore

53:30.64 DWYER IC Okay, alright, fine, that's okay. We probably should have led with that I'll leave it up to you to tell me. `flat fast 5.5w/s` If we get into anything that you think we don't need to get into, `fast 5.6w/s` you tell me and it'll save us some time, all right? `flat fast 6.3w/s` Don't worry about interrupting me on that score, OK?

(2.5s pause) Unreasonable delay on the 3rd of May. `↑+2.5st louder` Are we still dealing with this one? `wide fast 6.4w/s`

53:49.98 MR SHEPHERD So that's a different subject.

53:51.96 DWYER IC `flat` Queensland Health Payroll explicitly identified the errors and directed Ms Taylor to process corrections immediately. What errors are you talking about there? Failed to action the urgent directive until the 28th of May. `flat` So I recall that we don't need to go over that too because I've recalled that. `flat` That's all I need to know. `flat fast 7.5w/s` If you think we don't need to go over it, we can skip over. `fast 6.5w/s louder` Stressor 3, we're getting there. `↑+2.8st` Admitted breaches of statutory fatigue management. Mathematical reality of the work health and safety breach. On the 17th and 18th of March 2024, the employer rostered the appellant to work consecutive shifts separated by a mere seven-hour break.

(2.1s pause) factoring in the appellant's established commute the appellant was subjected to 16 hours of wakefulness work `flat` and 4 hours of high risk commuting `flat` leaving approximately 4 hours of actual sleep `flat` so this is going to need `wide`

54:47.86 MR SHEPHERD roster for the relevant period I have everything for this I have everything for this `wide`

54:54.76 DWYER IC so we don't need to go into this one? No. Okay. Flagrant bypass of the Neville safety mandate despite prior warnings. Are we going into that? We don't need to go into that. Okay. Awesome. Unjustified administrative detriment. When the appellant predictably required recovery time, is that all part of the same thing? It's all part of the same thing, yes. You've got all the documents for `fast 5.4w/s` that? Yes. Admitted unreasonableness, the regulator's own independent review office, `flat` office, IRO. Got all that? Okay. And then the last one, which isn't necessarily identified `wide` as a stressor, but I'll go to it anyway. 12th and 16th of July, 24, while incapacitated by a certified psychological leave, the employer scheduled meetings regarding his complaint. On 8 October, the employer terminated the appellant under abandonment provisions despite despite holding continuous medical certificates, the appellant was subsequently reinstated. `wide` Okay. During proceedings, the respondent unilaterally obtained the appellant. So this is after you sustained your injury? `louder`

55:59.66 MR SHEPHERD `flat quieter` Yeah. Okay. `flat` All right. `wide quieter`

(2.6s pause) Are there any documents in relation to any of that that you think... `flat` No, I have all of that. `flat fast 9.7w/s` Okay. `flat` All right. `flat`

(3.1s pause) Has our discussion `↑+3.1st wide`

(3.7s pause)

56:17.34 DWYER IC `flat quieter` focused your understanding of what your case is to the extent of what documents might or might not be necessary? `flat`

56:26.18 MR SHEPHERD `wide` I think I can get it easier in a path that I could probably really scope a lot of that. `flat` Yeah. `↑+2.6st wide quieter`

56:34.32 DWYER IC `↑+4.2st` I think it's important. I understand you're acting for yourself, Mr Sheppard, I do, and I understand that you're, you know, and in no way at all being critical in this respect, `flat fast 5.3w/s` you're floundering around a bit, you know, because you're not sure what you need to do `wide fast 5.6w/s` and what you don't need to do. `↓-2.1st fast 6.9w/s` And oftentimes people do make what I think is the mistake `flat` of, you know, overcooking it. `flat` Your case, you've got to keep coming back to those stressors, but also what you can and can't prove. `wide`

(3.0s pause) Ultimately, there's parts of this that are going to need documents, `flat fast 6.5w/s` but it sounds like not the sort of volume of documents you're talking about. `flat` You, I think, have as a broader grievance a view that, you know, systemically, `wide slow 0.8w/s quieter` the place in which you worked had a number of failings and problems related to aid manager and non-compliance with proper protocol, procedure, legislation, et cetera.

(2.0s pause) I may just be speculating about that `wide` but I get the sense that you've got that broader grievance and it's important to `quieter` and you may be right about all of that `fast 5.2w/s louder` you don't have to go too far `wide` in any public sector or any organisation really I shouldn't beat up the public sector `flat` but in any organisation to find `wide` failures to comply with legislation failures to comply with protocol failures to comply with policy `flat` it happens every single day in every single workplace `wide` place. It's a question of whether or not there's anything material that arises from any of that and people do it all the time and it's only a problem if somebody gets sacked or somebody gets killed or somebody, you know what I mean? And it's only then when these things get a light shone on them and they become relevant. So understand, I think, that you have, looking at your material, you have that broader grievance. But you need to understand for the efficient conduct of this appeal that it's about those matters that you've identified `wide` as being causative of your medical condition. `flat` And it's not about you proving that this was a terrible place, a toxic place, `flat` that there's multiple examples of ways they didn't comply with this or didn't do that or should have done that. `flat fast 5.4w/s` It's not a broad-brush criticism of what you regard as the systemic failings of the organisation. `flat` organisation, your case must focus on the stressors that you've identified and to the extent that you need documents to support those, from what I can see from them it's `quieter` a much shorter list. What I would rather do than subject everybody to a full blown hearing `wide` hearing about your Form 29, and I'm not closed to that idea if you really wish to press it, I'm not closed to that at all, but I would, I think you will find Ms Matheson is sufficiently `wide` objective and cooperative to have a constructive discussion with the regulator. They have responsibilities `wide` as a model litigant, okay, so they can't hide stuff from you, they can't be sneaky or tricky hearing like that, they will operate in the way that I've always experienced them operating

59:53.24 MR SHEPHERD `flat` both as a commissioner and as a practitioner, appearing against them on many occasions as

59:58.40 DWYER IC professionals. And if there's a document that you can properly identify as being something that they can readily access through their liaison with the health service, then they should be able to provide it to you. But it'll be subject to constructive discussions about `wide` about, well, what is it? How do we identify it? How's it relevant? Those sorts of things. And if there is a document in those discussions that Ms Matheson says, well, yeah, we know it exists, but we don't think it's relevant, you can come back to me. And looking at a single document, I can tell you very quickly whether it should be disclosed or shouldn't be disclosed. There's also a case of being able to identify it, okay? But your case shouldn't `wide` be about, I'm loathe to say you can't and can do things, but to assist you, you need to focus on the stressors that you rely on to support the contention that you've sustained an injury within the meaning of the act. You don't need to prove it was an overall toxic `flat` place to work and Miss Taylor or whatever her name is, your supervisor was a terrible `flat` manager, et cetera. You don't need to prove all of that. You need to prove the matters `flat` that you've identified in the stressors `flat` as being causative of your injury. And as I said, that's a much shorter scope `flat` in terms of documents.

`↓-2.3st flat` Fewer documents means simpler case, ` $\uparrow+3.2st$ ` means easier for someone like me to understand it and not get it wrong.
`flat fast 6.6w/s`

61:23.96 MR SHEPHERD `quieter` Okay?

61:26.10 DWYER IC ` $\uparrow+2.1st$ ` So this is what I'm... I should just, before I move on, `fast 5.0w/s` anything arising out of all of that, Ms Matheson? Have I misrepresented your role in the matter or placed a burden on you that you're not prepared to accept? `flat fast 5.1w/s`

61:37.14 MR SHEPHERD `flat` No. All right. ` $\downarrow-11.3st$ `

61:39.12 DWYER IC `wide` And Ms. Rutland, any? Okay, all right. ` $\uparrow+2.6st$  wide quieter` So what I want to do is this, ` $\uparrow+3.3st$ ` and I'm open to the parties telling me otherwise, `flat fast 5.2w/s` but this is what I want to do. `fast 8.3w/s` I'd like to park the Form 29 for a little bit longer and hopefully with some meaningful discussions, `wide` having taken on board what we've talked about this morning, Mr. Shepard, you can formulate a view about whether there are any... `flat` Look at what you've got. `fast 6.0w/s` Look closely at what you've got from the regulator later in terms of disclosure to this point, and if you feel like there's still something that you can say for `wide` certainty exists, so look, I remember that Ms Taylor sent us emails routinely during this `slow 1.3w/s` period. If you're going to talk about those things that we talked about before, which was the unassessed directives or whatever, you might be on to something there. They might have an obligation to provide those. `flat` they're likely to come out one way or the other ` $\uparrow+2.8st$  louder` either they give them to you and you have them or you contend they were sent and they produced them `wide` during the course of the proceedings `flat` it seems to me that those are going to be more about the character of those emails as opposed to whether they were actually sent or not `flat` so the fact that you make the assertion that you were sent these emails needs to be addressed by the regulator and to that end they're likely going to produce them if they haven't disclosed them already then that probably that's probably something you need to look at that that `wide` particular point is the one one area I think in all of what we've been through `flat` that there might be something to look at but over the course of the next few `quieter` weeks if you want to have a think about the question of disclosure and attempt `flat` to have some constructive polite and professional discussions with Mathis with Miss Matheson I'm sure you will be able to achieve that and it may be that you managed to whittle this list right down to next to nothing if not nothing `flat fast 4.9w/s` thing. And then you can get on with the important business of getting this thing to a hearing. Okay? Yep. ` $\uparrow+3.8st$  quieter` Sound like a plan? Sounds good. Alright. Any objections ` $\uparrow+2.9st$  quieter` to this just being stood down for about four weeks and `wide` pending a hearing back from Mr Sheppard about whether he wishes to press any part of it? No, thank you, Commissioner. Ms Rutten, is that `quieter` alright with you? Yes, Your Honour, that's fine, thank you. Alright. And you're okay? `quieter` OK, so I'll stand it down for four weeks, give you a chance to take on board what I've talked about and recalibrate your thoughts, `wide` and then if you still wish to press any aspect of it, we'll get down to the serious business `flat` of dealing with your specific application, OK? `flat` But I'm hopeful that if you take on board what I've said today and you have some discussions with Ms Matheson, you may find your way through this in a much simpler way. `wide` OK? All right. `wide quieter`

64:28.94 MR SHEPHERD All right.

64:29.68 DWYER IC `flat` Nothing further? Nothing further? `quieter`

64:33.38 MR SHEPHERD ` $\downarrow-5.8st$  fast 5.0w/s` All right.

64:33.80 DWYER IC `flat` Thanks, Paddy.

 NOT PART OF THE RECORD — READER'S NOTES ON FOUR CONTESTED PASSAGES

****Everything above this rule is the transcript. Everything below it is commentary and must never be quoted, served or tendered as though it were part of the record.**** These notes exist so that four passages whose meaning has been argued over are not re-argued from memory. Each cites the timestamp and is checkable against the text above. Full reasoning: ``skill/references/MENTION-7AUG2026-ASSESSMENT.md` §99` and ``skill/references/TRANSCRIPT-ACCURACY-comparison.md``.

N1 — [16:29] "*I guess I did request*" — the passage where ASR choice changes the meaning

Engine	Rendering
faster-whisper small.en	<i>"I didn't request, but I didn't be specific about that."</i>
large-v3 (this transcript)	<i>"I guess I did request, but I didn't be specific about that."</i>

Opposite meaning, on the central question of the morning — whether the Regulator had been asked first. On **small.en** he never asked; on **large-v3** he asked, imprecisely. **large-v3** is the measured-more- accurate engine (9,616 words vs 9,343; mean segment

confidence -0.180, none below -0.59; zero hallucinations found against two in small.en). 🚫 **Never cite the small.en rendering of this line.**

N2 — [23:37]–[26:31] "filters" is not a vocabulary gap

A phrase is the criterion; a filter is the mechanism that applies it. At [23:40] the Appellant named the system (eHealth/Outlook), the operation ("you put a word in ... and it filters all the words"), the criterion ("effective immediately"), the scope (the manager's sent mail, A–E) and the output sought ("I basically just want the count"). ★ **That is a complete specification of a bounded search, given live and unprepared.** The Commissioner did not retrieve the operation from the word, having said in the same hearing that his brain switches off under load. ⇒ **Read this passage as the Appellant explaining a technical concept to the bench, never the reverse.**

N3 — [43:36]–[46:52] "actively suppressed" — a concession and a self-correction

At [46:10], to "actively means they deliberately — am I right about that?", the answer was "**I don't know if I can prove it as much.**" At [46:44], unprompted, he re-specified: "it wasn't actively **spread**, it was actively avoided, but would be more likely."

★ A concession against interest followed by a more accurate substitute word, produced live. **The pleaded adverb was wrong; the underlying facts — interest expressed April 2023, thirteen months, never formally installed, the union chasing — are untouched.**

✅ **"spread" CONFIRMED by re-decode, 16 September 2026.** An earlier version of this note proposed that "spread" (p=0.23) might be a mis-recognition of "suppressed". **That hypothesis is refuted.**

A targeted re-decode of the audio at beam 10 returned "spread" in **three of four valid passes**, including the only pass run with **no prompt priming at all** (p=0.20). The single "suppressed" reading came from the pass most primed toward that word by the operator's own domain prompt.

The semantic objection was also wrong: the subject of the clause is **the correspondence**, not the appointment — "The correspondence I also got from the manager, but it wasn't actively spread, it was actively avoided"* — and correspondence can of course be spread. **The transcript was right.**

N4 — [51:24]–[52:04] the comparator class slides mid-answer

"Between me and my colleague" [51:47] → "**My colleagues generally** because I would be rostered off" [51:52], after the Commissioner offered both alternatives. △ A 42% figure computed against **one** comparator was restated as holding against **the group**. **A precision defect, not a vocabulary one.** The fix is a fixed sentence: one named comparator, one stated period, one figure.

Provenance of this file. Audio `PRF0466309\_20260807\_QIRCOIR\_Brisbane`. Segment data:

`MENTION\_7AUG2026\_segments.jsonl`. Diarisation method: `diarise\_inferential.py`. All three are kept together so the diarisation is reproducible; none may be deleted independently of the others. △ **No certified transcript exists.** Request ATR0282381 to QTranscripts was for **audio only** and the notification of 18 August 2026 is a request record, not a transcript. **This file, and the small.en text it supersedes, are machine-generated and uncertified.**